[METRIC]

A-A-2812A
April 1, 1994
SUPERSEDES
A-A-2812
November 5, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FOLDER, FILE; AND FOLDER, FILE, HANGING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description, for all Federal agencies

1. Scope: This description covers file folders and hanging file folders made from 0.28 mm thick (11 point) paperboard of various colors, without fasteners.

2. Classification: Folders shall be of the following types, styles, sizes and colors.

Type 1 - Folder, File
Type 2 - Folder, File, Hanging

Style A - Straight Cut, Self Tab
Style B - Double Top, Straight Cut, Self Tab
Style C - 1/2 Cut, Self Tab
Style D - Double Top, 1/2 Cut, Self Tab
Style E - 1/3 Cut, Self Tab
Style F - Double Top, 1/3 Cut, Self Tab
Style G - 1/5 Cut, Self Tab
Style H - Double Top, 1/5 Cut, Self Tab
Style I - Hanging File Folder with Slotted Top for Insertable Tabs

Type 1 is available in Styles A, B, C, D, E, F, G, and H. Type 2 is available only in Style I.

Size 1 - Letter Size
Size 2 - Legal Size

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, N.Y. 10278.

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Color - Shall be as specified in the contract or order.

3. Salient characteristics.

3.1 Construction. File folders and hanging file folders shall be made from paperboard conforming to the requirements of Table I. When necessary to achieve the specified color, the paperboard shall be dyed or tinted. Tabs on Type 1 file folders shall be an extension of the back leaf.

3.1.1 When a double top is specified, (Styles B, D, F, H), the tab and the top of the folder shall be made from 2 sheets of paperboard conforming to the requirements of Table I that are of the specified color and are securely glued together. The double top shall extend across the entire width of the folder and shall extend not less than 13 mm (1/2 inch) beyond the bottom of the tab.

3.1.2 The top corners of the folder and the ends of the tabs shall be rounded on Type 1 file folders. Rounded corners may include "S" curves.

3.1.3 On Type 1 file folders, lines shall be embossed across the entire width of the front leaf, parallel to the fold. Either 2 lines at 10 mm (3/8 inch) intervals with the first line 10 mm from the fold, or 3 lines at 6 mm (1/4 inch) intervals with the first line 6 mm (1/4 inch) from the fold are acceptable. On Type 2 hanging file folders, 4 lines shall be embossed across the entire width of each leaf, 6 mm (1/4 inch) apart, parallel to the fold, beginning 6 mm (1/4 inch) from the fold. In addition, each leaf of Type 2 hanging file folders shall have 1 line embossed across the entire width of the leaf 152 $\pm$ 2 mm (6 $\pm$ 1/16 inches) from the fold, parallel to the fold.

3.1.4 When specified, an insertable tab shall be furnished with each Type 2 hanging file folder. Tabs shall be made from clear, flexible, plastic and shall include blank white paper inserts with enough space for 3 lines of type. Tabs shall have projections that fit in the tab attaching slots of Type 2 hanging file folders and secure the tabs to the folders. Tabs shall be uniformly cut and free from dirt, rips, scratches, blisters, discoloration, or any other defects which may affect their durability, appearance, or serviceability. Third cut tabs shall be 89 $\pm$ 3 mm (3-1/2 $\pm$ 1/8 inches) long; fifth cut tabs shall be 51 mm $\pm$ 3 mm (2 $\pm$ 1/8 inches) long.

3.1.5 Type 2 hanging file folders shall have tab attaching slots centrally located along the top of each leaf. Size 1 folders shall have 11 slots located 26 mm center to center along the middle 260 mm (10-1/4 inches) of the upper edge of each leaf. Size 2 folders shall have 13 slots located 26 mm center to center along the middle 312 mm (12-1/4 inches) of the upper edge of each leaf. Slots shall accept the third cut and the fifth cut insertable tabs specified above.

3.1.6 Type 2 hanging file folders shall have metal hangers attached to each leaf so that the folders can be suspended on rails inside file drawers. Each end of the hanger shall be shaped to form a hook. Hook design shall be in accordance with Figure 1, below. The overall length of the hangers shall be not less than 318 mm (12-1/2 inches) for Size 1 file folders and or not less than 394 mm (15-1/2 inches) for Size 2 file folders. The outer portion of the hooks, which does not rest on the rails, may be curved. Points or sharp edges on the hangers shall be eliminated by chamfering, filleting, grinding or other means. Hooks shall be coated with an organic compound or polymer, such as nylon, to reduce friction so that the folders can slide easily along the rails. Type 2 folders shall pass the Hanger Test specified below in Section 2., QUALITY ASSURANCE.

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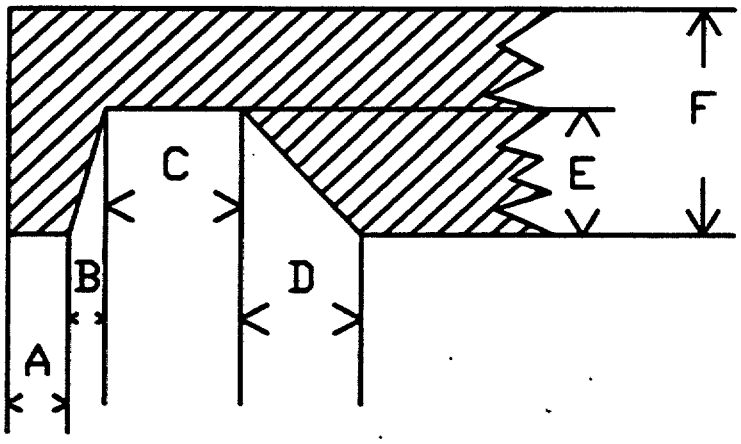
3.2 Dimensions.

3.2.1 Type 1 file folders. The horizontal length of the front and back leaves shall be 298 mm ± 2 mm (11-3/4 inches ± 1/16 inches) for Size 1 folders and 375 mm ± 2 mm (14-3/4 ± 1/16 inches) for Size 2 folders. The vertical length of the front and back leaves shall be 225 mm ± 2 mm (8-7/8 ± 1/16 inches), excluding the tab. The tab shall extend 16 ± 2 mm (5/8 ± 1/16 inch) beyond the rest of the back leaf.

3.2.2 Type 2 hanging file folders. The horizontal length of the front and back leaves shall be 298 mm ± 2 mm (11-3/4 inches ± 1/16 inches) for Size 1 folders and 375 mm ± 2 mm (14-3/4 ± 1/16 inches) for Size 2 folders. The vertical length of the front and back leaves shall be 237 mm ± 2 mm (9-5/16 ± 1/16 inches). Hangers shall be made from metal not less than 0.64 mm (0.025 inch) thick.

Table I, Physical Properties of Paperboard

PROPERTY	REQUIREMENT	TOLERANCE	TAPPI Test
Thickness	0.28 mm (0.011 inch)	+ 0.01,- 0.02 mm (+ 0.0004 - 0.0008 inches)	T 411
Stiffness	Machine direction, 5.0 mN*m Cross direction, 2.5 mN*m	+ unlimited, - 0.0 mN*m	T 489
Smoothness	Felt side, 2550 SCCM Wire side, 2550 SCCM	+ 0 SCCM, - unlimited	T 538
Internal Tearing Resistance	Machine direction, 2450 mN	+ unlimited - 0 mN	T 414



Minimum Dimensions,

A = 2.0 mm (0.079 inch)

B = 1.2 mm (0.047 inch)

C = 4.5 mm (0.18 inch)

D = 4.0 mm (0.16 inch)

E = 4.4 mm (0.17 inch)

F = 8.0 mm (0.31 inch)

Figure 1. Detail of hook design

3.3 Workmanship. Folders shall be clean and free from hard shives, dirt, spots, holes, blisters, tears, or wrinkles and shall have a

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smooth uniform finish. Edges shall be cleanly cut, without nicks or ragged edges. Die cuts to make rounded corners may remain as long as they can be easily removed. Folders and tabs shall be free from any other defects that may affect their serviceability or appearance.

4. Quality Assurance:

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.3 Physical Properties of Paperboard. TAPPI tests shall be in accordance with TAPPI T400 for the applicable TAPPI test methods.

4.4 Sampling and Testing. File folders, hanging file folders, and shipping containers shall be sampled in accordance with MIL-STD-105, as indicated below, for the cited examinations and tests.

4.4.1 Examination of File Folders and Hanging File Folders for Construction, Dimensions, and Workmanship. The lot size shall be expressed in file folders or hanging file folders. The sample unit shall be 1 file folder or 1 hanging file folder. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, the AQL shall be 2.5% defective.

4.4.2 Testing of Type 2 Hanging File Folders. The lot size shall be expressed in hanging file folders. The sample unit shall be 1 hanging file folder. The Inspection Level shall be S-1, the AQL shall be 2.5% defective.

4.4.2.1 Hanger Test. Hanging file folders selected for this test shall be suspended from the hooks at each end of the back leaf. The front leaf shall be left free to fall open. Weights of 1500 $\pm$ 50 g (3.31 $\pm$ 0.11 pounds) for Size 1 folders, or 1875 $\pm$ 60 g (4.13 $\pm$ 0.13 pounds) for Size 2 folders, shall be attached to each hook of the front leaf. The weights shall be allowed to hang freely for not less than 5 minutes. Then the weights shall be removed and the folders taken down.

4.4.2.1.1 Examine the folders to determine if any seam separation has occurred in the area where the hangers are inserted into the folder. If there is any seam separation on either leaf, the folder is defective.

4.4.2.1.2 After the folders have been examined for seam separation, place 50 sheets of 75 g/m^2 (20 pound, 17 x 22-500) xerographic copy paper in each folder. Use 216 x 279 mm (8-1/2 x 11 inches) paper for Size 1 folders and 216 x 356 mm (8-1/2 x 14 inches) paper for Size 2 folders. Suspend each folder containing the copy paper inside a

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file drawer using a file drawer frame or built in side rails. Slide the folder along the frame. If the folder does not slide easily along the frame without binding or snagging, the folder is defective.

5. Regulatory requirements. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard for the manifold paper shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% post consumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated October 20, 1993 (See definition of post consumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504(b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.1 Recycled Content Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

6 Preservation, Packaging, Packing, Labeling, and Marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein: The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

(1) TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.
(2) MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.
(3) Copies of Executive Order 12873, dated October 20, 1993 may be obtained from: The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building,White House, Att: Publications,Washington, DC. 20500 (202) 395-7332

8 Note:

8.1 File folders and hanging file folders should be ordered in standard commercial colors whenever possible. Kraft and manila are standard commercial colors for file folders. Green is a standard commercial color for hanging file folders.

9 Ordering data: Purchaser should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A) Type, style, size, and color required;
B) Tab position required on Type 1 file folders;
C) When third cut or fifth cut insertable tabs are required with Type 2 hanging file folders;
D) Whether bleaching without the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or chlorine compound is required.
E) Packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

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9.1 Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (for cataloging use only)

AA2812 - 1G2 This example describes a legal size and 1/5 cut self tab file folder.

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        | | |
        | | |
        | | | Size 1, Letter Size
        | | |- Size 2, Legal Size
        | |
        | |  Style A, Straight Cut, Self Tab
        | |  Style B, Double Top, Straight Cut, Self Tab
        | |  Style C, 1/2 Cut, Self Tab
        | |  Style D, Double Top, Straight Cut, Self Tab
        | |  Style E, 1/3 Cut, Self Tab
        | |  Style F, Double Top, 1/3 Cut, Self Tab
        | |-- Style G, 1/5 Cut, Self Tab
        |    Style H, Double Top, 1/5 Cut, Self Tab
        |    Style I, Hanging File Folder with Slotted Top for Insertable Index Tabs
        |
        |--- Type 1, Folder, File
             Type 2, Folder, File, Hanging
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MILITARY INTERESTS:
Military Coordinating Activity
Army - GL

Custodian, Air Force - 99
Reviewer, Air Force - 84

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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